
INTO THE HEART OF THE NORTH-EAST

Kanchenjunga Express, *Silchar–Lumding*



Curved bridges, tracks, and almost never-ending tunnels, valleys, plantations, hills, and rivers are all packed into this 210-km journey into the north-eastern state of Assam. Known as the "pahad" or mountain line, the curvy tracks allow travellers to see the train twist and turn as it chugs through the mountains or peer over the edge at the rivers below. The new broad-

gauge line is as impressive as the old metre-gauge one, even though its construction proved as challenging as the first line in the 1880s. A key stop is New Haflong, which serves the state's only hill station, Haflong at nearly 700 m before ending its journey at Lumding, one of the oldest stations in the region.